

South Saharan Social Development Organization (SSDO) Condemns EFCC Chairman's Sweeping Allegations Against Nigerian Students; Demands Immediate Retraction

South Saharan Social Development Organization (SSDO) expresses its deep concern and strongly condemns the recent statement by the Chairman of the Economic and Financial Crimes Commission (EFCC), Ola Olukoyede, alleging that six in ten Nigerian students are involved in cybercrime.

While the fight against financial crimes is a necessary endeavor for national integrity, characterizing six out of every ten students as criminals is not only statistically questionable but deeply damaging to the morale and reputation of the nation's youth. Such broad-spectrum labeling undermines the hard work of millions of young Nigerians who are pursuing their education under challenging circumstances and striving to contribute honestly to the global economy.

As an organization dedicated to the empowerment and development of young people across the region, SSDO views these comments as a setback to youth advocacy and social inclusion. Generalizations of this nature fuel systemic bias, making it increasingly difficult for innocent students and young professionals to access international opportunities, internships, and employment.

Speaking on the matter, the Executive Director of South Saharan Social Development Organization, Dr. Stanley Ilechukwu, stated:

"We find the Chairman's remarks to be highly insensitive and unreflective of the true character of the Nigerian student body. Our youth are our greatest resource, and while we support the EFCC in its mandate to curb criminality, we must draw the line at rhetoric that criminalizes an entire demographic without nuance. These statements have the potential to stigmatize an entire generation and further erode the dwindling trust between the youth and state institutions."

SSDO believes that the focus should remain on creating an enabling environment for digital literacy and legitimate economic opportunities, rather than deploying rhetoric that alienates the very population the government seeks to reform.

We join other civil society organizations and student bodies in calling on the EFCC Chairman to provide the empirical data backing such a grave claim or, in the interest of national unity and youth development, issue a formal retraction and apology to the Nigerian students.

Our organization remains committed to fostering a society where young people are supported, not stereotyped, as they navigate their paths toward leadership and innovation.

Signed:

Dr. Stanley Ilechukwu

Executive Director,
South Saharan Social Development Organization (SSDO)

https://www.vanguardngr.com/2026/05/ssdo-raises-concern-over-efcc-chairmans-comment-on-nigerian-students/#google_vignette

<https://guardian.ng/news/efccs-statement-damaging-to-morale-reputation-of-nigerian-youths-group-laments/>